

PHYSICS OF SENSOR PROBLEMS

Q1. A platinum resistance thermometer has a resistance of $180\ \Omega$ at 20°C . Calculate its resistance at 60°C ($\alpha_{20} = 0.00392$)

Given:- $\alpha_{20} = 0.00392$, $R_0 = 180\ \Omega$

Formula:- $R = R_0 (1 + \alpha \Delta T)$

Solution:-

$$R = R_0 (1 + \alpha \Delta T)$$

$$R = 180 [1 + 0.00392 (60 - 20)]$$

$$R = 180 [1 + 0.00392 \times 40]$$

$$R = 180 [1 + 0.1568]$$

$$R = 180 \times 1.1568$$

$$R = 208.224\ \Omega$$

Ans:- The resistance at 60°C is $208.224\ \Omega$

Q2. A platinum resistance thermometer has a resistance of $100\ \Omega$ at 25°C . Find its resistance at 50°C . The resistance temperature coefficient of platinum is $0.00392\ \Omega / ^\circ\text{C}$.

If the thermometer has a resistance of $200\ \Omega$ calculate the value of temperature.

Given:- Resistance $25^\circ\text{C} = 100\ \Omega$

Formula:- $R = R_0 (1 + \alpha_0 \Delta t)$

Solution:-

Step1 :Using the linear approximations, the value of resistance at any temperature

$$R = R_0 (1 + \alpha_0 \Delta t)$$

$$R = 100(1 + [(0.00392) \times (50 - 25)])$$

$$= 100(1 + [(0.00392 \times 25)])$$

$$= 109.82$$

Step2 :Suppose t_2 is the unknown temperature then

$$200 = 100(1 + [(0.00392) \times (t_2 - 25)])$$

$$2 = (1 + [(0.00392) \times (t_2 - 25)])$$

$$2 - 1 = [(0.00392) \times (t_2 - 25)]$$

$$(t_2 - 25)^\circ\text{C} = \frac{1}{0.00392} \text{ therefore, } t_2 = 280^\circ\text{C}$$

Ans:- The value of temperature is 280°C